

Lab 01 — Static Website Hosting with Azure Blob Storage

Hands-on training lab · Junior cloud support portfolio

Resource group	Region	Storage account	Hosting method
rg-gp-static-website	North Europe	stgpstaticsite65621599	Blob Storage static website

Objective

The lab focused on using Azure Storage's static website hosting feature to publish an HTML site directly from a Blob Storage container, without a traditional web server, to configure a custom 404 error page, and to publish an updated version of the site to the same endpoint.

Technologies

Microsoft Azure · Azure Blob Storage · Static Website Hosting · Azure Portal · HTML

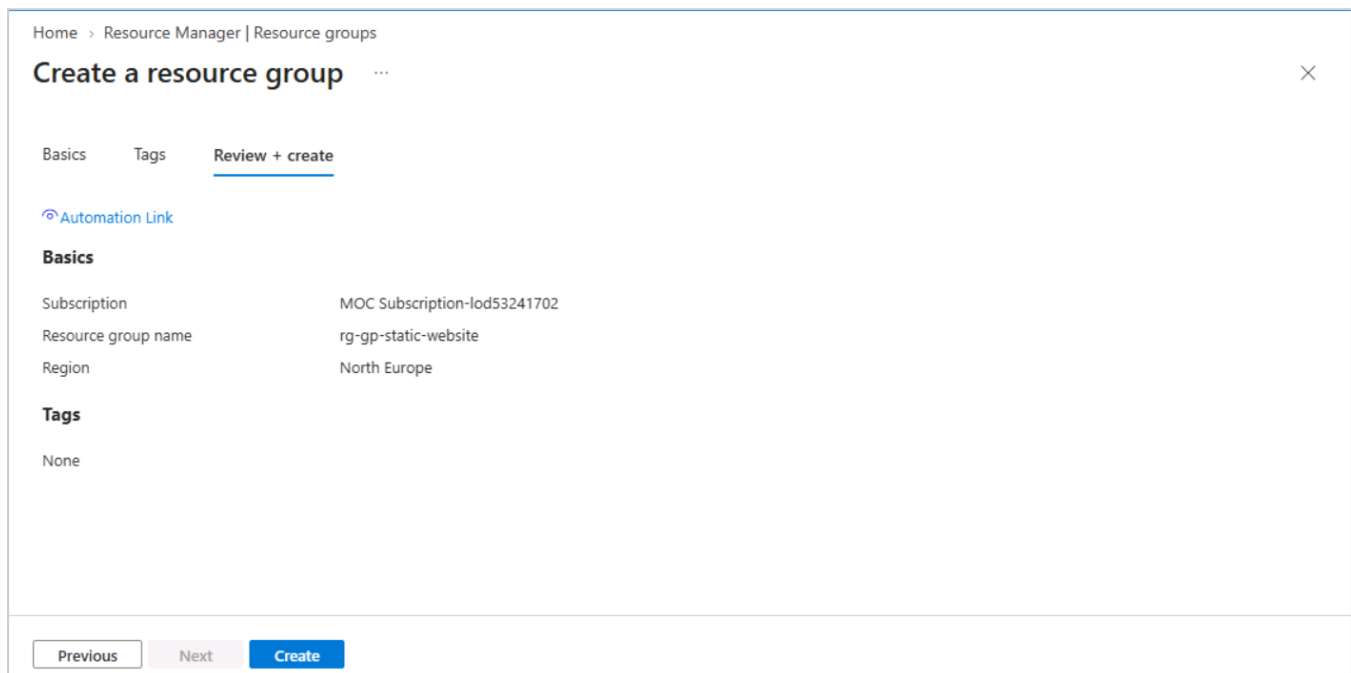
What I did (shown in the screenshots)

- Created the resource group rg-gp-static-website in North Europe
- Created the storage account stgpstaticsite65621599 (Standard performance, locally redundant storage)
- Enabled static website hosting on the storage account
- Set index.html as the index document and 404.html as the error document path
- Uploaded index.html and 404.html to the auto-created \$web container
- Verified the live site at the primary static website endpoint
- Verified the custom 404 page by browsing to a path that does not exist
- Prepared and uploaded an updated index.html as version 2, handling the overwrite prompt
- Verified version 2 was live at the same endpoint

Version note: the version 2 upload dialog blocked the first attempt because "Overwrite if files already exist" was left unchecked. The "Publishing Version 2" section shows that screen and how it was resolved.

Creating the Resource Group and Storage Account

The first step was creating a resource group to hold the lab's resources, then a storage account inside it. Both were created in North Europe under the same subscription.



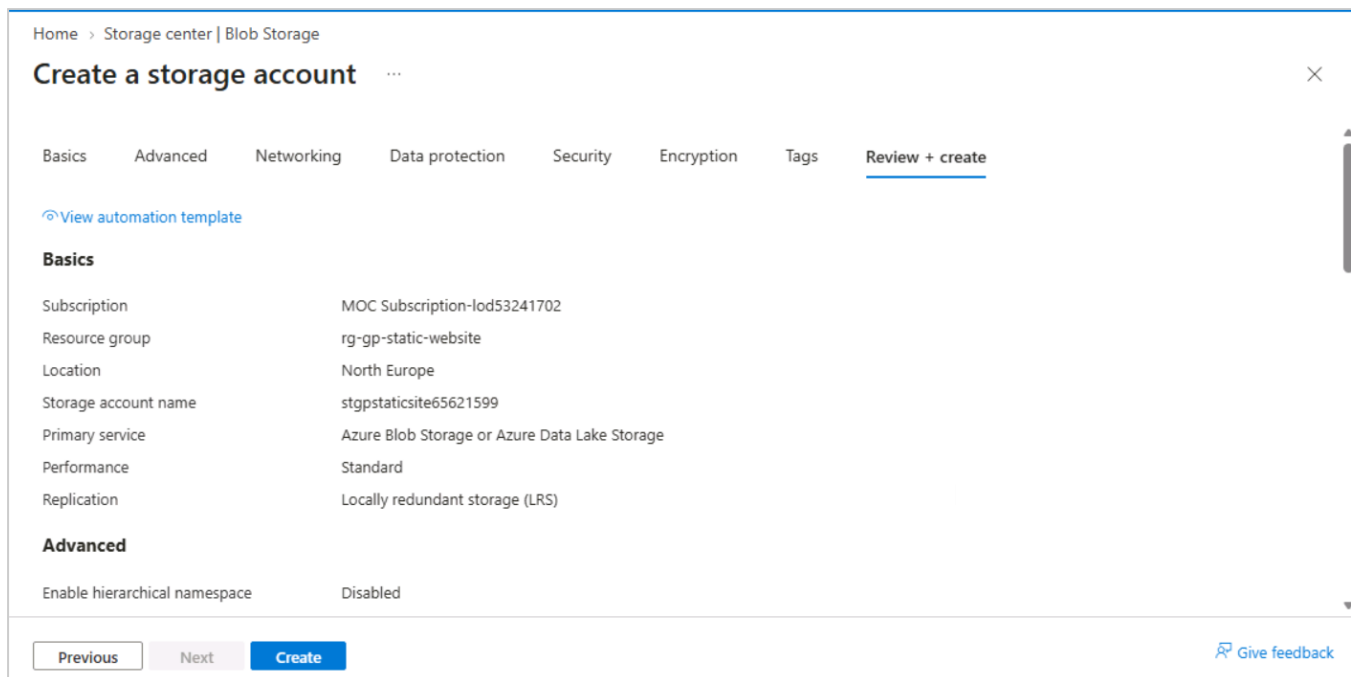
The screenshot shows the 'Create a resource group' wizard in the Azure portal, specifically the 'Review + create' tab. The breadcrumb navigation at the top reads 'Home > Resource Manager | Resource groups'. The title bar says 'Create a resource group' with a close button. Below the title are tabs for 'Basics', 'Tags', and 'Review + create'. A link for 'Automation Link' is present. The 'Basics' section displays the following configuration: Subscription is 'MOC Subscription-lod53241702', Resource group name is 'rg-gp-static-website', and Region is 'North Europe'. The 'Tags' section shows 'None'. At the bottom, there are 'Previous', 'Next', and 'Create' buttons.

Basics	
Subscription	MOC Subscription-lod53241702
Resource group name	rg-gp-static-website
Region	North Europe

Tags	
Tags	None

Figure 1 — Review + create screen for the resource group `rg-gp-static-website` in North Europe.

The storage account `stgpstaticsite65621599` was created inside `rg-gp-static-website`, also in North Europe, using Standard performance with locally redundant storage (LRS) and hierarchical namespace disabled.



The screenshot shows the 'Create a storage account' wizard in the Azure portal, specifically the 'Review + create' tab. The breadcrumb navigation at the top reads 'Home > Storage center | Blob Storage'. The title bar says 'Create a storage account' with a close button. Below the title are tabs for 'Basics', 'Advanced', 'Networking', 'Data protection', 'Security', 'Encryption', 'Tags', and 'Review + create'. A link for 'View automation template' is present. The 'Basics' section displays the following configuration: Subscription is 'MOC Subscription-lod53241702', Resource group is 'rg-gp-static-website', Location is 'North Europe', Storage account name is 'stgpstaticsite65621599', Primary service is 'Azure Blob Storage or Azure Data Lake Storage', Performance is 'Standard', and Replication is 'Locally redundant storage (LRS)'. The 'Advanced' section shows 'Enable hierarchical namespace' is 'Disabled'. At the bottom, there are 'Previous', 'Next', and 'Create' buttons, along with a 'Give feedback' link.

Basics	
Subscription	MOC Subscription-lod53241702
Resource group	rg-gp-static-website
Location	North Europe
Storage account name	stgpstaticsite65621599
Primary service	Azure Blob Storage or Azure Data Lake Storage
Performance	Standard
Replication	Locally redundant storage (LRS)

Advanced	
Enable hierarchical namespace	Disabled

Figure 2 — Review + create screen for the storage account `stgpstaticsite65621599`, Standard / LRS.

Enabling Static Website Hosting

Static website hosting was enabled on the storage account's Static website page. This automatically creates a \$web container to hold the site content and exposes a primary endpoint. The index document was set to index.html and the error document path to 404.html.

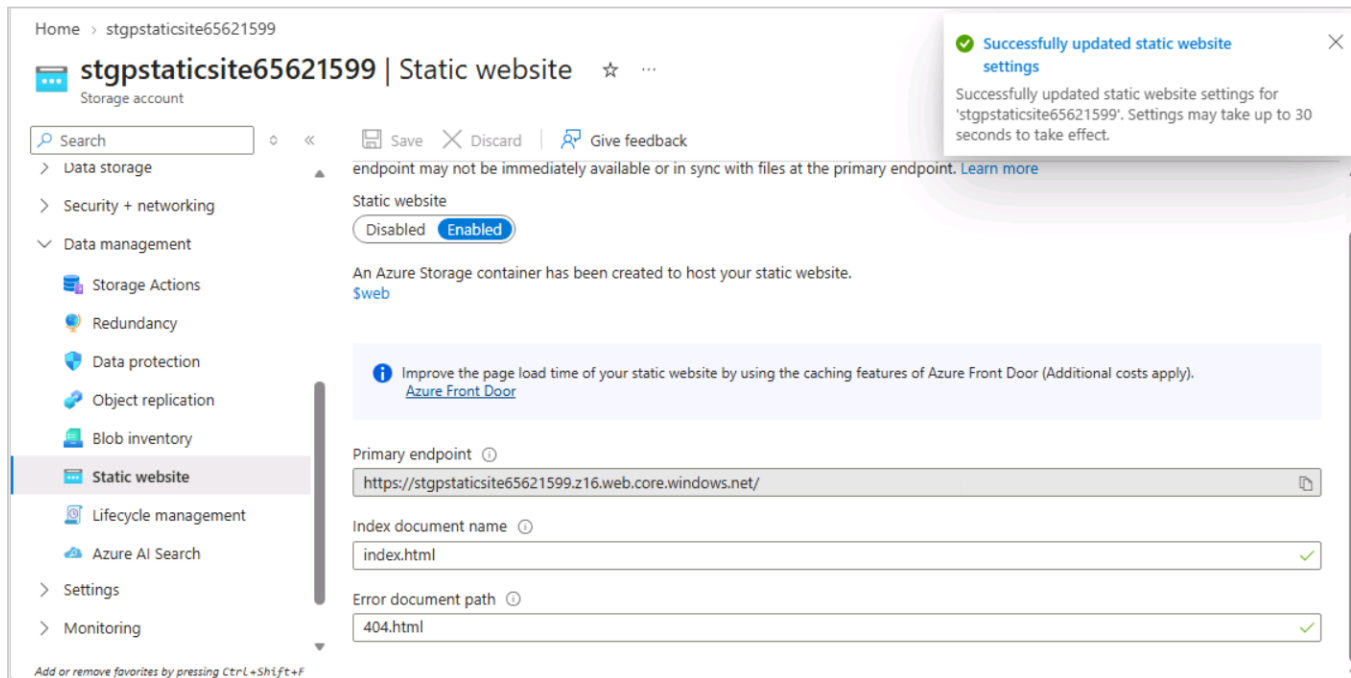


Figure 3 — Static website enabled, with the primary endpoint `https://stgpstaticsite65621599.z16.web.core.windows.net/`, index document `index.html` and error document path `404.html`.

`index.html` and `404.html` were then uploaded into the \$web container that Azure created automatically.

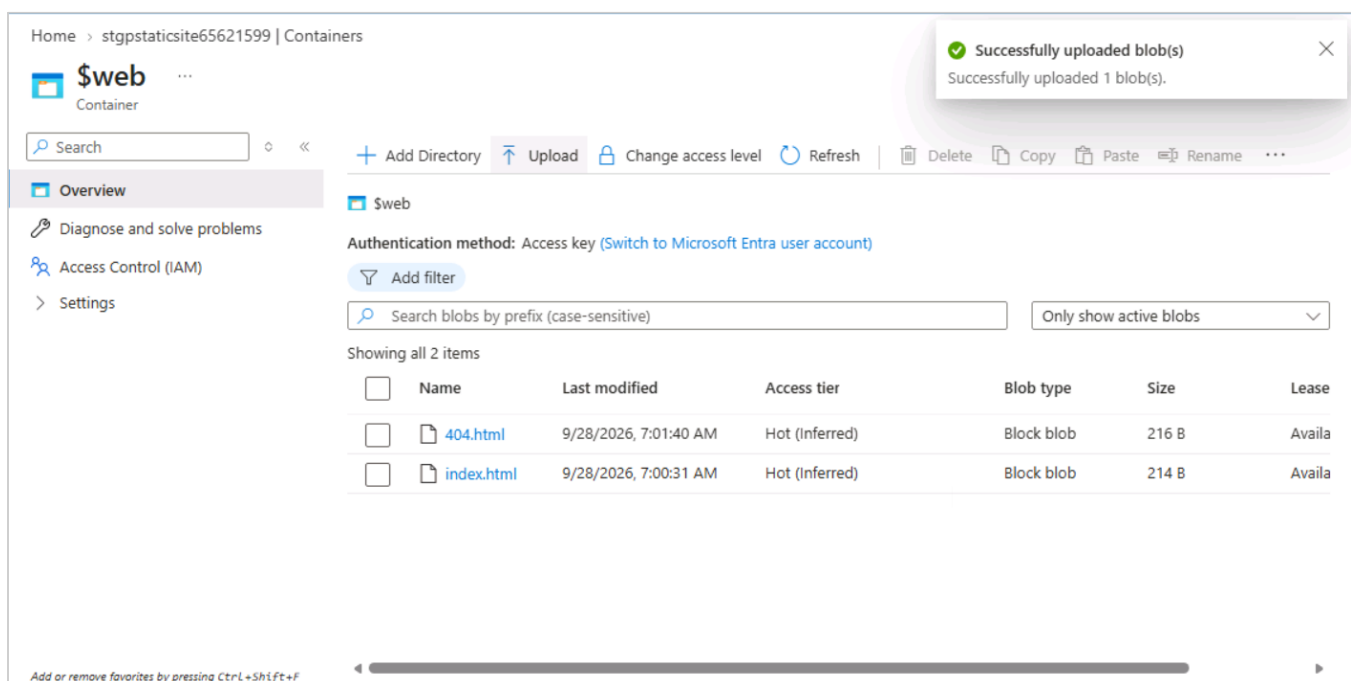


Figure 4 — The \$web container after upload, showing `404.html` and `index.html` as block blobs.

Verifying Version 1 and the 404 Page

Browsing to the primary endpoint served index.html directly from Blob Storage, confirming the site was live without any web server involved.

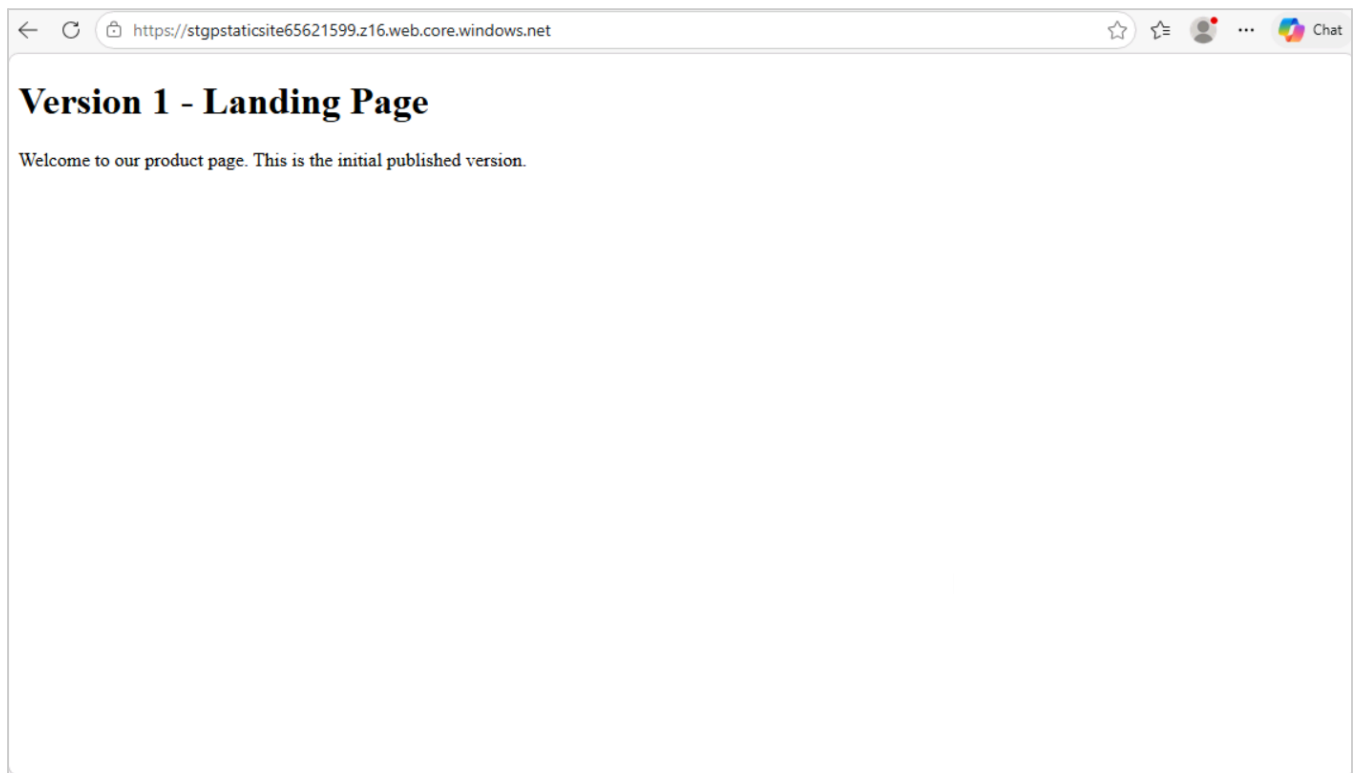


Figure 5 — Version 1 of the site live at the primary endpoint: "Version 1 - Landing Page".

Browsing to a path that does not exist on the site (/fakepage) returned the custom 404.html page instead of a generic error, confirming the error document path was configured correctly.

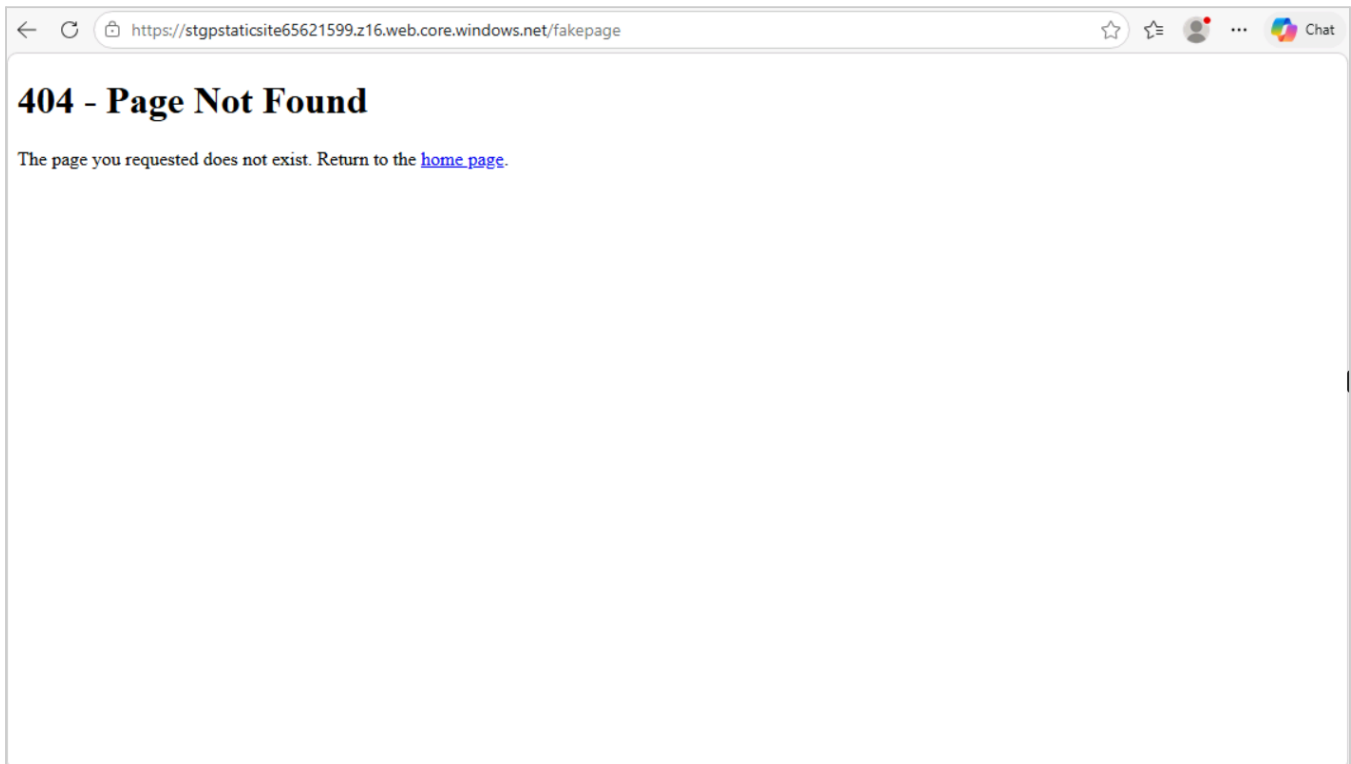


Figure 6 — Custom 404 page returned for the non-existent path /fakepage.

Publishing Version 2

To publish an update, a new index.html was uploaded to the same \$web container. The first upload attempt was blocked because "Overwrite if files already exist" was left unchecked, and the portal reported that index.html already existed.

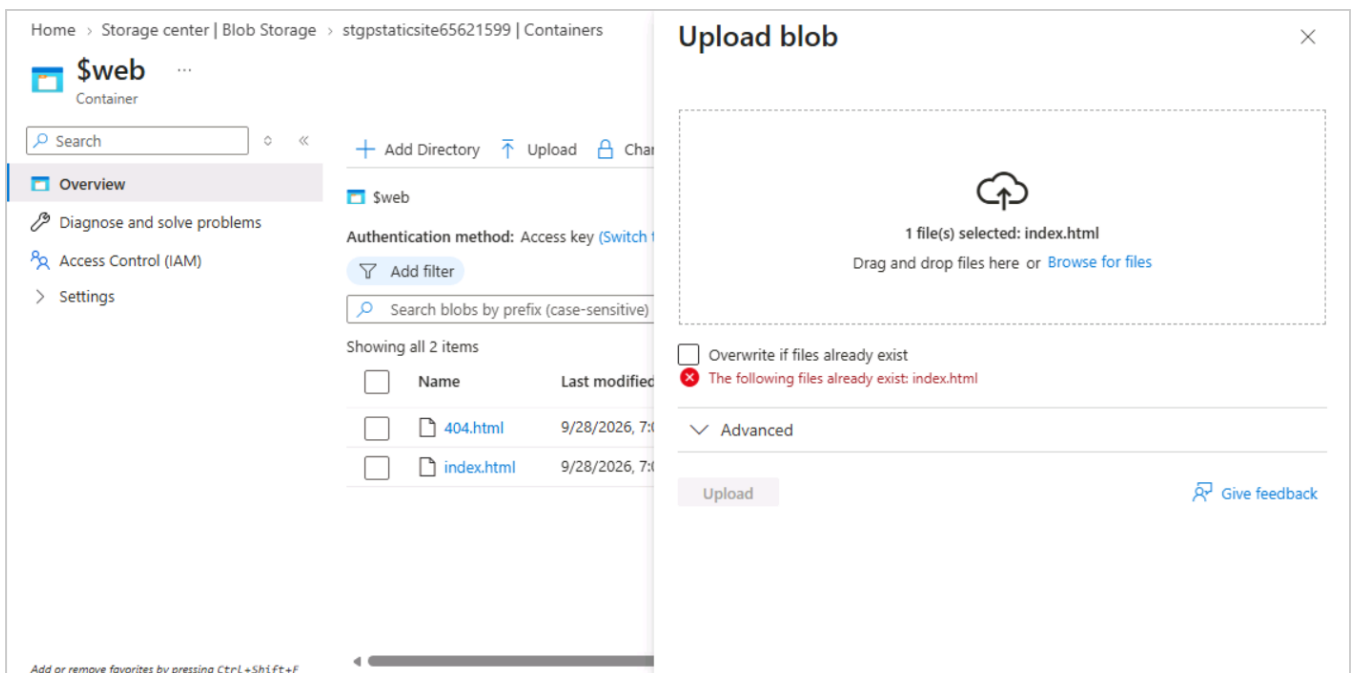


Figure 7 — Upload blob dialog for index.html, blocked with "The following files already exist: index.html" because Overwrite was not selected.

Resolution: checking "Overwrite if files already exist" and re-running the upload replaced index.html with the version 2 content. That confirmation screen is not shown; the result is shown next.

Reloading the primary endpoint after the overwrite served the updated page, confirming the second version was published successfully to the same static website endpoint.

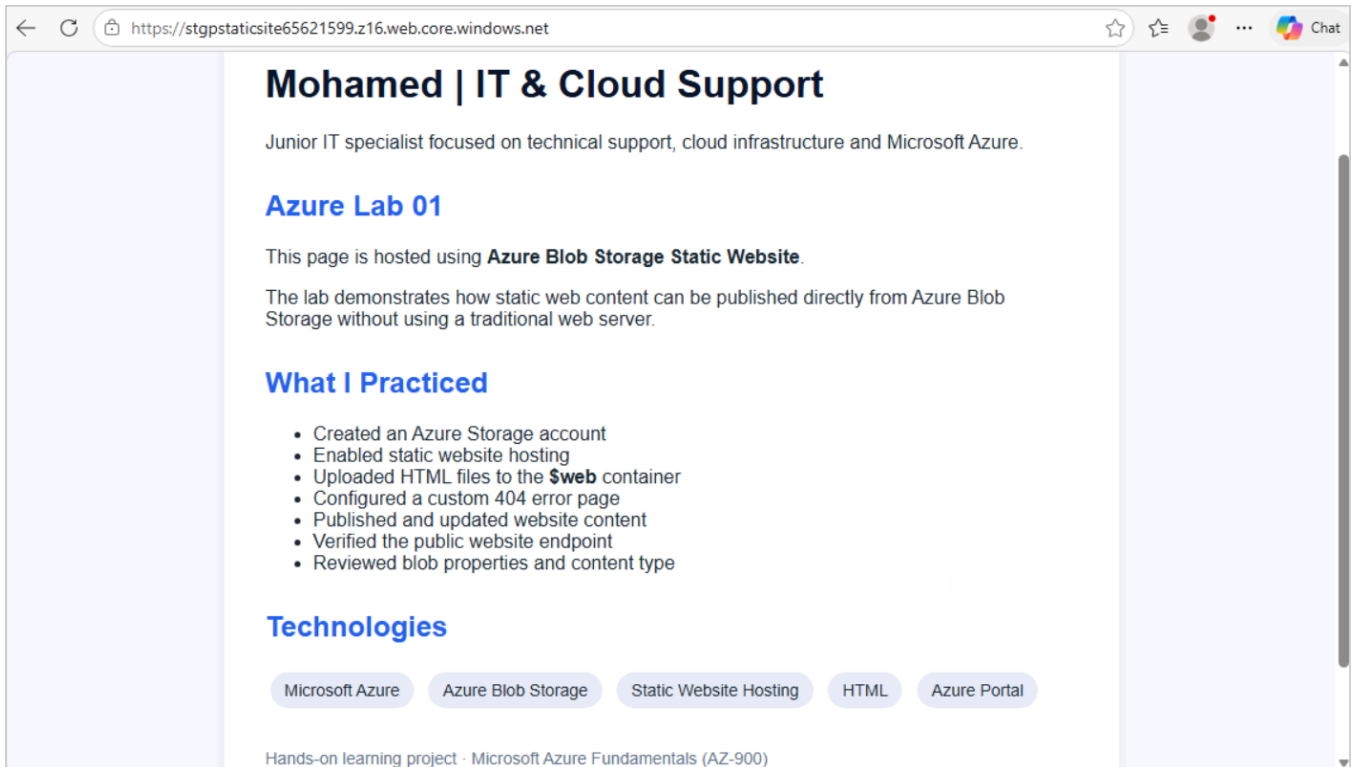


Figure 8 — Version 2 live at the same endpoint: the "Mohamed | IT & Cloud Support" Azure Lab 01 summary page.

What I Learned

- How to host static HTML content directly from Azure Blob Storage, without a traditional web server
- How the \$web container is created and used once static website hosting is enabled
- How the index document and error document path settings control what visitors see
- How to confirm a custom 404 page is working by requesting a path that does not exist
- That the portal blocks an overwrite by default, and how to allow it when re-publishing a file
- How to verify a published update by reloading the live endpoint

Notes on the evidence

All screenshots are shown complete and unedited. No access keys, connection strings, SAS tokens, passwords or personal email addresses appear in them. The Azure resources shown in this lab (rg-gp-static-website and stgpstaticsite65621599) have since been deleted; this was a training lab, not a production deployment.